

August 2026

Dear Americo,

I've worked in the Lamorinda market for a long time, and a property like 1603 Reliez Valley Road is the kind that genuinely stops you mid-scroll. One acre of hillside, a main home with four balconies and those views, and a Leon Meyer-attributed ADU with oiled redwood walls and walls of windows - that's not a combination you come across often in Lafayette. When I saw the listing come off the market at 105 days without a sale, I wanted to take a closer look at why.

The fundamentals here are genuinely strong, and that's what makes the outcome hard to reconcile. At \$545 per square foot on a property with this much character and this kind of compound potential, the value case was actually easier to make than most. My read is that the listing never quite solved the storytelling problem this property poses: two distinct structures, a designer architectural pedigree in the ADU, recreational amenities, and panoramic views all need to be experienced before a buyer will drive out for a showing. A standard MLS approach - a description, some photos, and time on the calendar - wasn't built to do that for a property this layered.

I've put together a short analysis of what I think the three main friction points were, along with a positioning breakdown of where this home sits in the Lafayette market today. None of it requires a commitment from you - it's just a clear-eyed look at the data and a sketch of what a different approach could accomplish.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside - no pressure at all. But if you're open to a conversation, I'd be glad to walk through this with you in person.

With respect,



Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

1603 Reliez Valley Road

Lafayette, CA 94549

7.0 Beds · 0 Baths · 4,314 Sq Ft · Lafayette

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 1603 Reliez Valley Road

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A One-Acre Hillside Compound with Architectural Depth - and a Listing That Never Brought It to Life

This property has the kind of assets Lafayette buyers at the upper end of the market actively search for and rarely find together: a refreshed 4-bedroom main home with vaulted ceilings, hardwood floors, and four balconies capturing panoramic hillside views, paired with a separate 1,660-square-foot ADU believed to have been designed by architect Leon Meyer and finished in oiled redwood with walls of windows. Add a Sport Court, an outdoor entertaining area with a BBQ, fountain, and arbor, a full acre of private hillside, and an EV charger, and the picture is of a compound that serves multiple life scenarios - multigenerational living, income generation, or a private guest retreat.

At \$545 per square foot, this listing came to market at a meaningful discount to the updated and premium Lafayette benchmarks. That number should have been a compelling entry point. Instead, the property sat for 105 days - well past the threshold where buyer psychology shifts from curiosity to skepticism. The listing description covered the facts, but it didn't build the experiential case for what living here actually means. A two-home compound with architectural character, hillside views, and a named design pedigree is not a property that sells on bullet points. It needed media and a narrative to match its actual depth.

\$2,350,000

List Price

\$545/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to accomplish one specific thing: give serious buyers - particularly those comparing Lafayette options in the \$2M-plus range - a reason to put this property in a category of its own before they ever schedule a visit. The compound format, the architectural story of the ADU, and the views are the proof points. They just need to be shown, not summarized.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 105 Days on Market Created a Stigma the Home Didn't Earn

After 105 days on the market, buyer perception had shifted well past the tipping point. The research is consistent: once a listing crosses roughly 45 days without going into contract, buyers stop asking what makes the home special and start asking what's wrong with it. For a property priced at \$2,350,000 - where buyers are comparing carefully and their agents are watching days-on-market closely - that stigma becomes a negotiating posture before anyone has even walked through the door. Nothing about the underlying property created this. A one-acre hillside compound with a Leon Meyer-attributed ADU doesn't lose its value in three months. The strategy ran out of runway before it found the right buyer.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork uses geo-targeted digital campaigns to actively reach SF and East Bay buyers who are researching Lafayette before they've found what they're looking for - so the right buyer finds this home before the days-on-market counter becomes the story.

Friction #2: The Visual Story of This Property Was Never Told

A compound with four balconies, panoramic hillside views, oiled redwood walls, and walls of windows is a property that lives or dies on visual media. Standard MLS photography - front elevation, room-by-room shots, flat interior lighting - cannot convey the spatial relationship between the two structures, the sense of privacy on one acre of hillside, or what it actually feels like to stand on one of those balconies and take in the view. The Leon Meyer design pedigree of the ADU is a genuine differentiator, but buyers scrolling through listings online have no way to feel that without the right visual context. At \$2,350,000, buyers are making emotional decisions backed by rational justification. If the emotional case isn't made in the media, the rational case never gets its turn.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

A Sky Tour would have shown buyers the lot position, the hillside setting, the relationship between the two structures, and the street presence in a way no ground photograph can replicate - turning a listing people scroll past into one they save and return to.

Friction #3: The Compound Format and ADU Pedigree Were Undersold as a Lifestyle

A two-home compound is not a straightforward listing - it requires a deliberate framing decision. Is this multigenerational living? A primary home with a premium income unit? A private retreat with a designer guest house? The listing description gestured at the ADU's architectural character, but it didn't stake out a clear identity for what this property is and who it's for. Buyers considering a \$2.35M purchase need to see themselves in the story before they'll commit to a showing. When a listing presents a layered, flexible-use property as a list of features without a point of view, buyers with different life scenarios all feel like it might not be right for them - and move on. This property has a genuinely compelling story. It just needed someone to tell it with conviction.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk through both structures independently from anywhere - so a buyer in San Francisco can fully understand the compound layout and the ADU's architectural character before deciding it's worth the drive to Lafayette.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	1603 Reliez Valley Rd	Lafayette Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$545/sqft	\$760–\$840/sqft (updated); \$650–\$720/sqft (fixer/unrenovated)
Lot / Setting	1.03 acres, private hillside with panoramic views	Typical Lafayette hillside lot: 0.3–0.6 acres
Architectural Character	Main home + separate ADU attributed to architect Leon Meyer; oiled redwood, walls of windows	Standard single-structure construction; rarely a named design pedigree
Premium Features	4 balconies, Sport Court, outdoor kitchen/BBQ area, EV charger, dual-address compound, built-in bar	Single living structure; outdoor amenities less common at this scale
HOA	None	Varies; many Lafayette communities \$0–\$200/mo

The verdict: At \$545/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$760-\$840/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$545 per square foot, this property came to market well below the updated Lafayette range of \$760–\$840 and significantly below the premium tier. The one-acre hillside setting, dual-structure compound format, and Leon Meyer-attributed ADU all support a stronger price-per-square-foot story than the listing ever made. The challenge was not the number - the challenge was that the marketing never built the case for why this property belongs in a different conversation than a standard single-structure Lafayette home. A relaunch that leads with the architectural character, the views, and the compound flexibility has real room to work with.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Rebuild the Visual Foundation Before a Single Buyer Sees the Listing

The relationship between the main home, the ADU, and the hillside acre is the core of what makes this property worth \$2.35M or more. That relationship cannot be communicated in standard room-by-room photography. Before this listing relaunched, it needs a complete visual rebuild: cinematic ground photography, a Sky Tour that places both structures in their setting, and a 3D Matterport walk-through of each building so buyers can orient themselves spatially before they ever schedule a showing. Buyers who understand the compound before they arrive are buyers who arrive ready to make an offer.

Pillar II - Give the Compound a Clear Identity and a Buyer to Speak To

A two-home compound with a designer ADU on one hillside acre serves several distinct buyer types: the multigenerational family that wants privacy between generations, the professional who needs a separate office or guest retreat, and the buyer who wants rental income without sacrificing the feel of a private estate. The relaunched listing needs to commit to a narrative that speaks to one of these buyers directly, then let the supporting features reinforce that story. BrightWork's listing remarks are written to move a buyer emotionally and then arm them rationally - not the other way around. That's the difference between a listing people read and a listing people respond to.

Pillar III - Reach the Buyer Pool Actively, Not Passively

At \$2.35M with no HOA, a rare compound format, and hillside views, this property's buyer is likely a well-resourced professional or family relocating from San Francisco or Oakland who is researching Lafayette neighborhoods before they've committed to a specific home. That buyer is not going to be captured by a standard MLS placement alone. BrightWork maintains an off-market private buyer list at offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers who have opted in to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. This home is worth showing to that list before a public relaunch, both to generate early momentum and to reset the days-on-market counter with clean, organic demand.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

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All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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